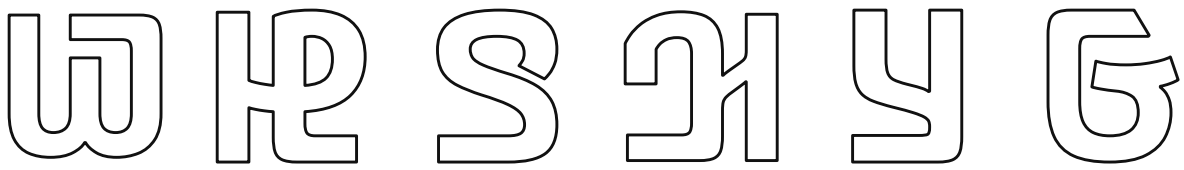
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 60

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Fula Alphabet

𞤀𞤣𞤤𞤀𞤥 𞤆𞤵𞤤𞤢

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 28 Letters of Adlam, the Fula Alphabet, with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Fula Alphabet — 𞤃𞤢𞤲𞤢𞤺 𞤀𞤤𞤦𞤢𞤲𞤢𞤼𞤫

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 60

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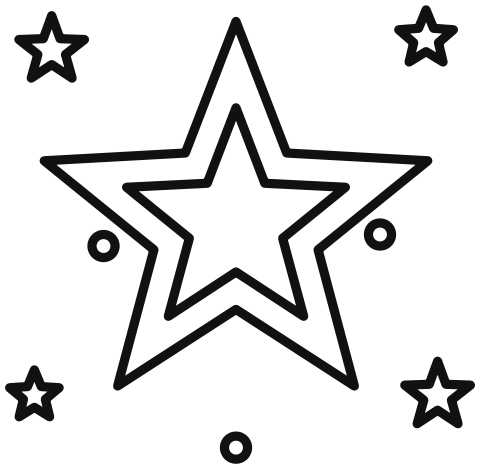
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Noto Sans Adlam, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License.
Map data: Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



This book belongs to

ꞏꞏꞏ

ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 60 is Fula. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Adlam is read from right to left**. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "they", *ii* as in "see", *oo* as in "door", *uu* as in "moon".
- **Doubled consonants are held a little longer:** *lekki* is "lek-kee".
- **CAPITALS** in the pronunciation show the stressed part of the word.
- **ɓ, ɗ, y̌** are special Fula sounds: say *b, d, y* while gently pulling air in. The transliteration keeps these Fula letters.
- Sounds follow the Pular of Guinea and the Pulaar of Senegal; other Fula regions say some words a little differently.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Fula name** written in Fula (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The third box shows the letter's **capital** and **small** shapes, the matching letter of the Fula **Latin** alphabet, and the small letter **joined** three times, as it looks inside a word.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Pular (Guinea) and Pulaar (Senegal).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Fula! 𞤆𞤵𞤤𞤢𞤲𞤣𞤮

pu-LAAR (also Pular, Fulfulde) — the Fula word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **35 million people** speak Fula, also called **Pulaar**, **Pular** or **Fulfulde**.[3]

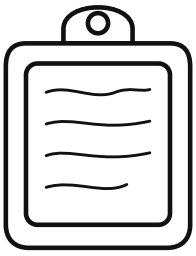
Where?
In a wide belt across **West and Central Africa**, from **Senegal** and **Guinea** to **Nigeria** and **Cameroon**. Most Fula families are **Muslim**.

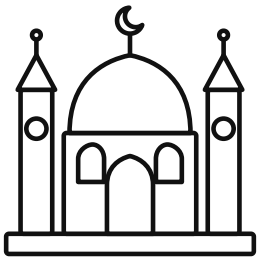
How is it written?
Fula is written in Latin letters, in Arabic letters (*Ajami*) and in **Adlam**, a new alphabet written from **right to left**.

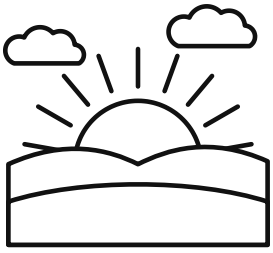
How many letters?
Adlam has **28 letters**, each with a capital and a small form, plus 6 extra letters for words from other languages.

Made by two boys!
In **1989**, two young brothers in Guinea, **Ibrahima and Abdoulaye Barry**, invented Adlam so that Fula could be written in its own letters.

What does ADLaM mean?
It is made from the first letters of 𞤀𞤣𞤤𞤢𞤥 𞤛𞤫𞤓𞤪𞤭𞤦𞤵𞤤𞤭 𞤛𞤢𞤥𞤧𞤢𞤲 𞤀𞤣𞤳𞤢𞤥𞤮𞤼 — “the alphabet that keeps the peoples from being lost”.







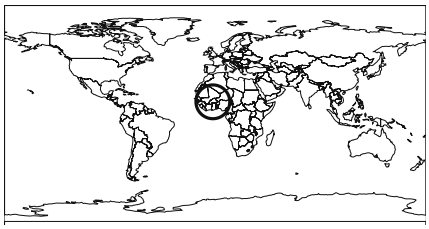
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Fula Alphabet 𞤆𞤵𞤤𞤢𞤦𞤢𞤣𞤫𞤵

28 letters — 𞤆𞤵𞤤𞤢𞤦𞤢𞤣𞤫𞤵

𞤐𞤫 *pe*	𞤔𞤔𞤲𞤾𞤲𞤾𞤭𞤾𞤱 *sinnyiiyhe*	𞤄𞤢 *ba*	𞤃𞤭𞤭𞤥 *miim*	𞤂𞤢𞤤𞤥 *laam*	𞤕𞤢𞤤𞤭 *daali*	𞤀𞤤𞤭𞤳 *alif*
𞤇𞤲𞤣𞤢 *dha*	𞤑 *o*	𞤔𞤭 *i*	𞤋𞤢 *fa*	𞤆𞤫 *e*	𞤉𞤫 *ra*	𞤄𞤲𞤱 *bhe*
𞤌𞤌𞤲 *jiim*	𞤅𞤵 *u*	𞤁𞤢 *ya*	𞤊𞤢𞤳 *kaf*	𞤎𞤢𞤲 *nun*	𞤐𞤢𞤲 *waw*	𞤘𞤫 *yhe*
𞤝𞤲𞤣𞤢 *nha*	𞤖𞤵 *tu*	𞤍𞤲𞤾𞤢 *nya*	𞤒𞤢 *ga*	𞤋𞤢𞤲𞤦 *qaaf*	𞤑𞤢 *ha*	𞤛𞤲𞤭 *chi*

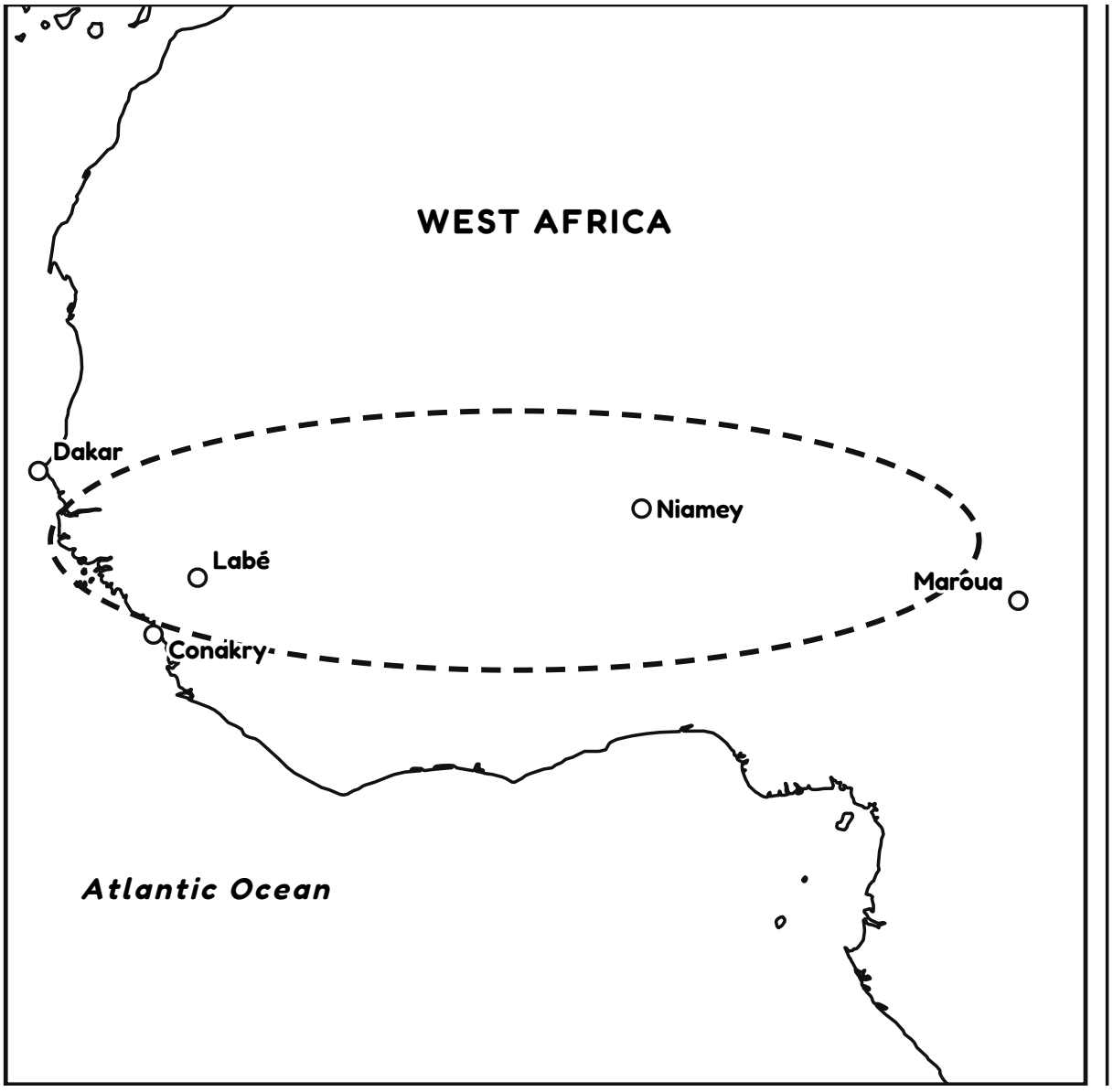
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows West Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Fula spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Fula is spoken all along the dashed area, from Dakar and Conakry to Niamey and Maroua. Adlam was born near **Labé**, in the hills of Fuuta Jaloo.

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The Letters 𞤀𞤤𞤥𞤢𞤪𞤣

al-KOO-leh — “the letters”

Adlam is written **from right to left**, like the Qur’an. Start reading each line on the right!

Big and small

Every Adlam letter has a **capital** and a **small** form, just like English:

𞤁 𞤓 · 𞤘 𞤲 · 𞤄 𞤆

Capitals start a sentence or a name: 𞤁𞥅𞤵𞤤𞤱.

Letters hold hands

Small letters **join** to each other inside a word, like Arabic:

𞤣𞤵𞥅𞤤𞤱 = 𞤣 + 𞤵 + 𞤣 + 𞤣 + 𞤱

s + u + u + d + u = suudu (house)

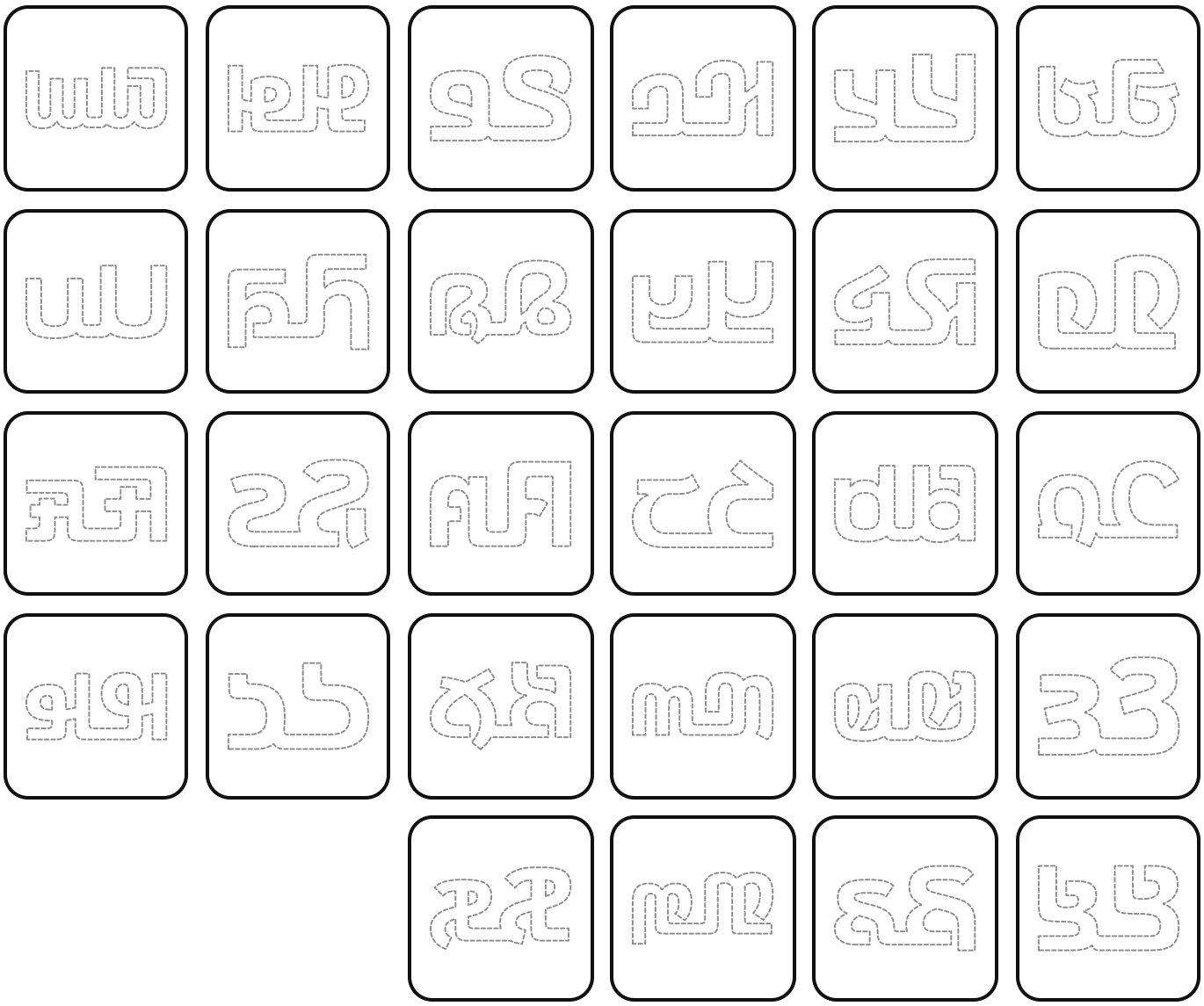
Little helper marks

𞥅 the long mark on **a** makes *aa*; 𞥄 makes the other vowels long (*ii, ee, oo, uu*); 𞥆 doubles a consonant (*ll*), as in 𞤷𞤵𞤪𞤣𞥅𞤵𞤷.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters ಕಾಗುಣಿತ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



𞤀

NAME · 𞤀𞤊𞤂𞤫𞤤

𞤀𞤤𞤦𞤭𞤥

alif

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

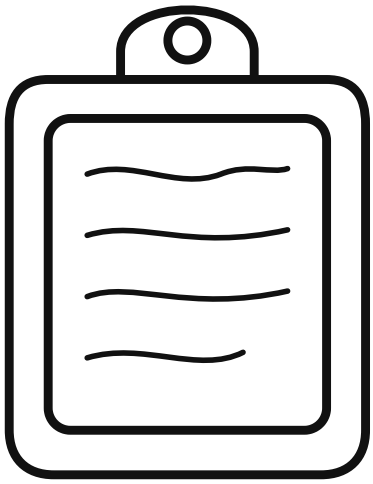
‘a’ as in “father”, but short; with the long mark ◌̄ it is ‘aa’

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤀 𞤢 A a

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤀𞤤𞤀



𞤢𞤢 IS FOR

𞤀𞤤𞤦𞤀𞤣𞤭

al-LOO-wal

wooden writing board (for learning the Qur’an)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤔𞤊𞤂𞤫𞤤𞤭

𞤀 𞤀 𞤀 𞤀

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𞤁𞤁

NAME · 𞤃𞤢𞤤𞤭𞤪

𞤁𞤢𞤤𞤭

daali

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “day”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤁 𞤁 D d

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤁𞤁𞤁



𞤁𞤁 IS FOR

𞤃𞤭𞤂𞤢𞤪𞤮𞤣𞤭

def-TEH-reh

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤃𞤢𞤂𞤭𞤤𞤭𞤥

𞤁𞤁 𞤁𞤁 𞤁𞤁 𞤁𞤁

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𞤤

NAME · 𞤔𞤫𞤥𞤢

لَلّو

laam

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

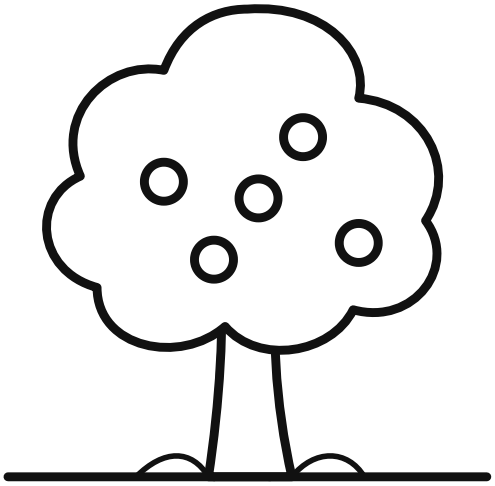
'l' as in "lamp"

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤤 𞤬 𞤤𞤬

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤤𞤤𞤤



𞤤𞤬 IS FOR

لِكي

LEK-kee

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤔𞤫𞤉𞤢𞤧𞤬

𞤤𞤬 𞤤𞤬 𞤤𞤬 𞤤𞤬

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𞤑𞤢

NAME · 𞤀𞤍𞤂𞤫𞤤

𞤑𞤢𞤤𞤮

miim

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

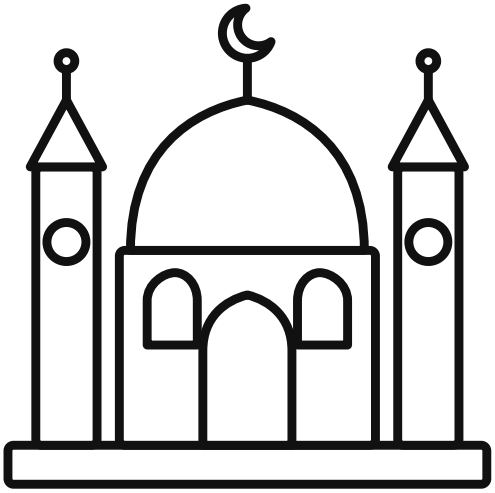
‘m’ as in “moon”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤑 𞤢 M m

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤑𞤑𞤑



𞤑𞤢 IS FOR

𞤑𞤢𞤤𞤪𞤭𞤧𞤭𞤣𞤫

mee-SEE-deh

mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤀𞤍𞤂𞤫𞤤𞤭

𞤑𞤢 𞤑𞤢 𞤑𞤢 𞤑𞤢

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𞤁𞤢

NAME · 𞤄𞤢𞤑𞤭𞤤

𞤄𞤤

ba

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

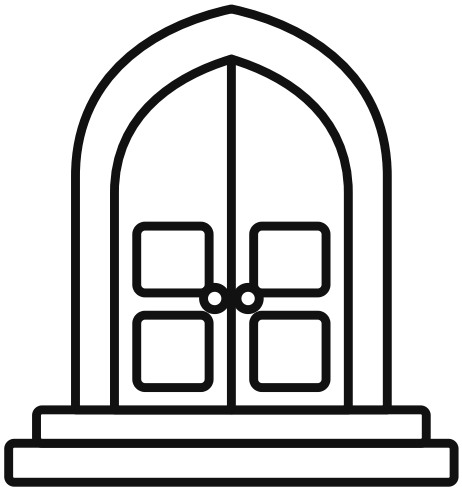
‘b’ as in “ball”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤄 𞤁 B b

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤁𞤢𞤁𞤤



𞤁𞤢 IS FOR

𞤁𞤢𞤊𞤫𞤤

BAA-fal

door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤄𞤢𞤑𞤭𞤤𞤍

𞤁𞤢 𞤁𞤢 𞤁𞤢 𞤁𞤢

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𞤔𞤔

NAME · 𞤑𞤢𞤥𞤫

𞤔𞤤𞤢𞤦𞤲𞤢𞤣𞤲

sinnyiiyhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

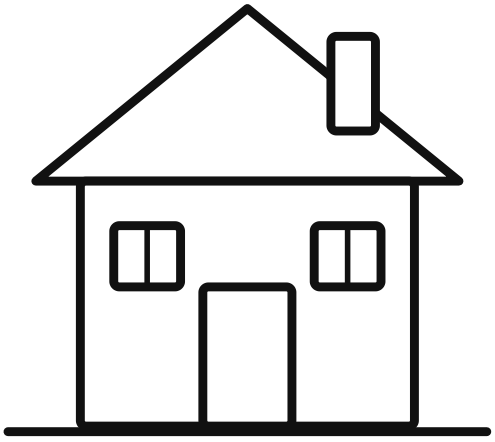
‘s’ as in “sun”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤔 𞤔 S s

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤔𞤔𞤔𞤔



𞤔𞤔 IS FOR

𞤔𞤢𞤳𞤮

SOO-doo

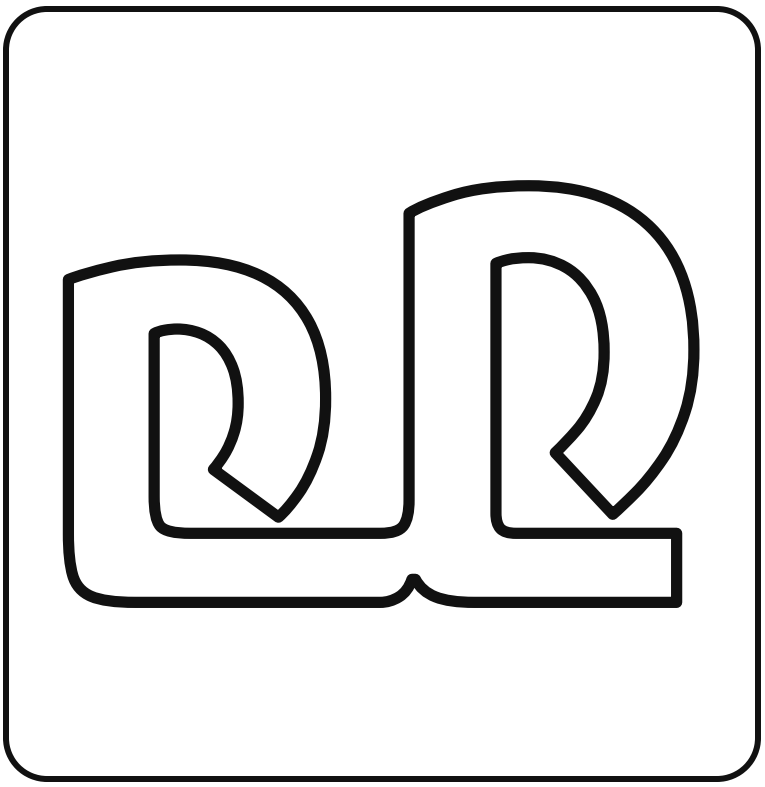
house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤑𞤢𞤥𞤫𞤲𞤣

𞤔𞤔 𞤔𞤔 𞤔𞤔 𞤔𞤔

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NAME · 𞤄𞤢𞤫𞤲𞤵

𞤄𞤢

pe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

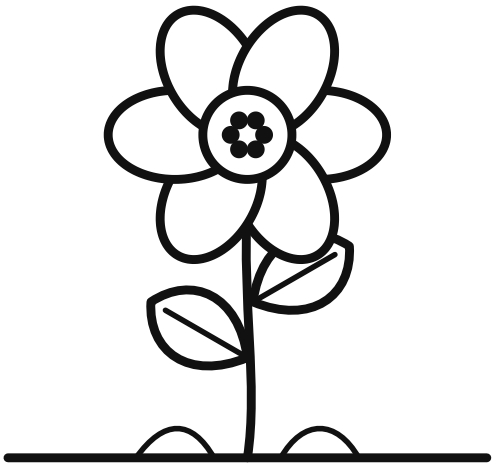
‘p’ as in “pen”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤀 𞤢 P p

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤄𞤢𞤄



𞤄𞤢 IS FOR

ﻣﻴﺪﻱ

PEEN-dee

flowers

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤄𞤢𞤫𞤲𞤵𞤤

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NAME · 𞤆𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥

𞤆𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥

bhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

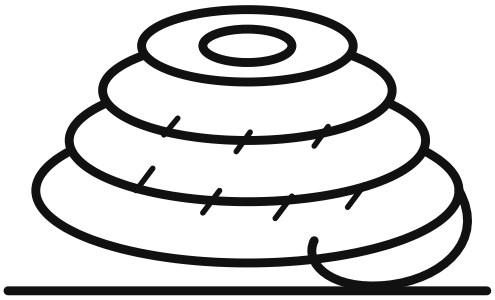
a ‘b’ said while gently pulling air in — a special Fula sound

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤓 𞤕 Ɓ ɓ

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤓𞤓𞤓



𞤕𞤕 IS FOR

𞤓𞤮𞤳𞤮𞤴𞤤

ƁOG-gol

rope

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤆𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥𞤲



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𞤕𞤕

NAME · 𞤁𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥

𞤕𞤤

ra

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

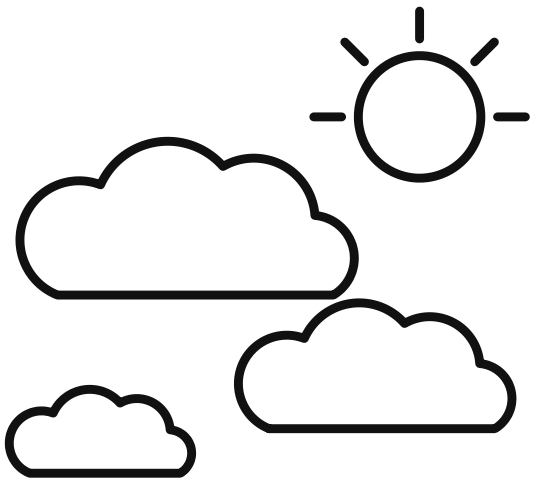
a rolled ‘r’

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤔 𞤕 R r

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤕𞤕𞤕



𞤤𞤤 IS FOR

𞤁𞤢𞤪𞤫𞤤𞤫

ROOL-deh

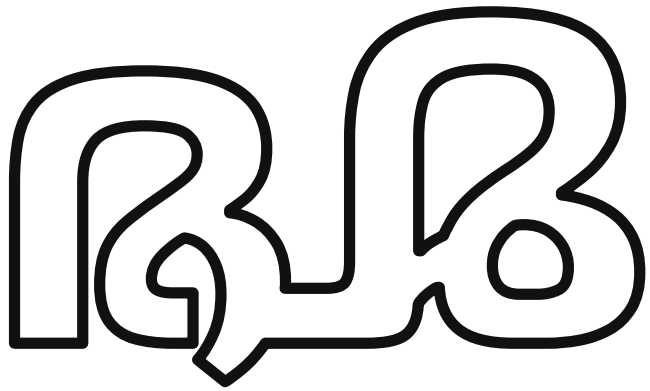
cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤁𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥𞤲

𞤕𞤕 𞤕𞤕 𞤕𞤕 𞤕𞤕

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NAME · 𞤈𞤫𞤥𞤢𞤤

𞤈

e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤄 𞤈 E e

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤈𞤈𞤈

Very few Fula words start with E. Find 𞤈 inside 𞤊𞤢𞤈𞤢!



𞤈𞤈 IS FOR

𞤊𞤢𞤈𞤢

LEW-roo

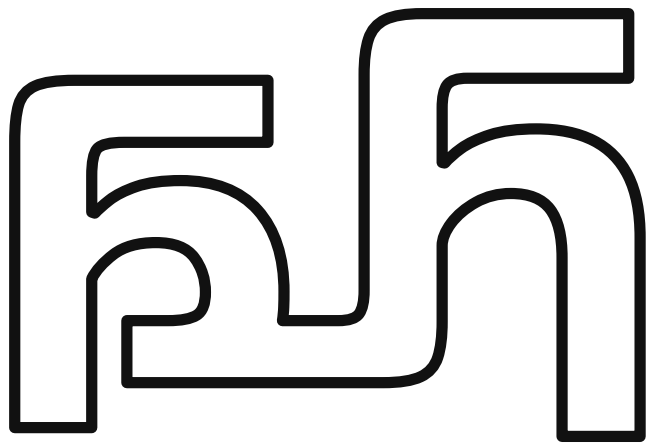
moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤊𞤫𞤔𞤢𞤤𞤣



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NAME · 𞤆𞤢𞤥𞤫

𞤆𞤵

fa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

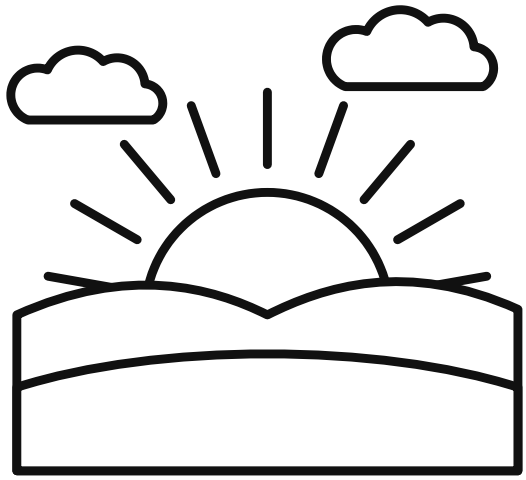
‘f’ as in “fan”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤄 𞤵 F f

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤄𞤄𞤄



𞤵𞤤 IS FOR

𞤆𞤵𞤣𞤢𞤲𞤲𞤢𞤲𞤾𞤫𞤪

fuɗ-NAAN-geh

the east, where the sun rises

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤆𞤢𞤥𞤫𞤲

𞤵 𞤵 𞤵 𞤵 𞤵

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𞤔𞤵

NAME · 𞤀𞤤𞤦𞤢𞤥

U

i

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘i’ as in “sit”; with the long mark ◌ً it is ‘ee’ as in “see”

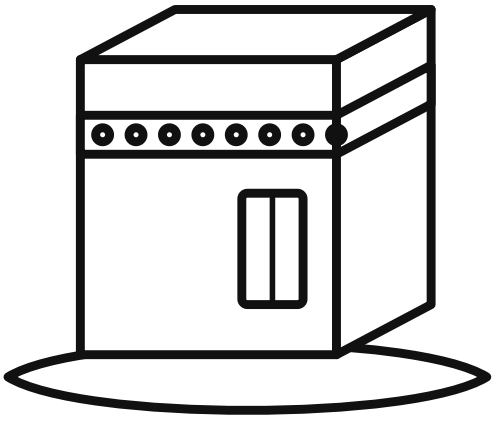
CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤔 𞤵 𞤔𞤵

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤔𞤔𞤔

A name starts with a capital letter, so Islaam begins with the big U.



𞤔𞤔 IS FOR

𞤋𞤔𞤔𞤤𞤢𞤣𞤫

is-LAAM

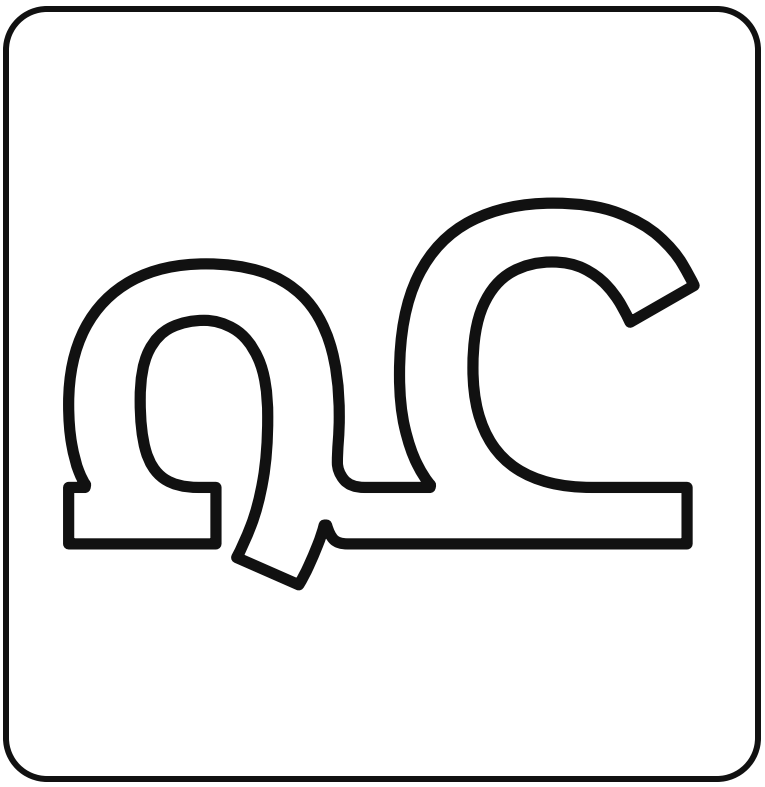
Islam

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤚𞤦𞤀𞤔𞤀

𞤔𞤵 𞤔𞤵 𞤔𞤵 𞤔𞤵

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NAME · 𞤈𞤢𞤫𞤤𞤵

𞤃

o

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “for”, short and round

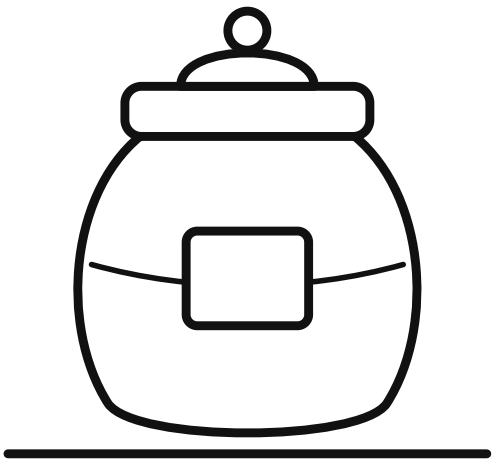
CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤃 𞤓 𞤯 𞤫

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤃𞤯𞤓

Very few Fula words start with O. Find 𞤃 inside 𞤈𞤢𞤴𞤣!



𞤃𞤓 IS FOR

𞤈𞤢𞤴𞤣

LOON-deh

big water jar

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤈𞤢𞤫𞤤𞤫𞤥

𞤃𞤓 𞤃𞤓 𞤃𞤓 𞤃𞤓

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𞤣𞤢

NAME · 𞤣𞤢𞤤𞤥

𞤣𞤢

dha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

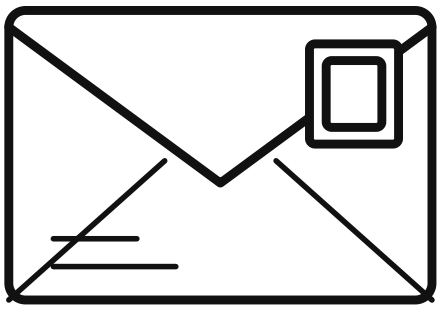
a ‘d’ said while gently pulling air in — a special Fula sound

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤁 𞤣 Ɗ ɗ

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤣𞤣𞤣



𞤣𞤢 IS FOR

𞤣𞤫𞤲𞤪𞤫𞤱𞤤

ƊEH-reh-wol

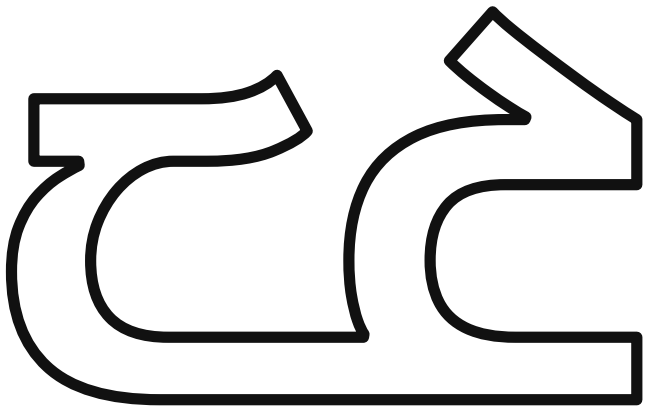
sheet of paper, a letter

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤣𞤢𞤤𞤥𞤪

𞤣𞤢 𞤣𞤢 𞤣𞤢 𞤣𞤢

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NAME · 𞤲𞤢𞤥𞤫

𞤲𞤣𞤳

yhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘y’ with a little catch in the throat — a special Fula sound

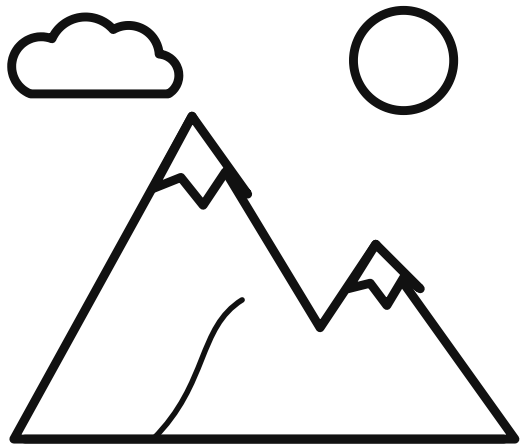
CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤓 𞤣 Ƴ ƴ

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤓𞤓𞤓

Ƴ rarely starts a word. Find 𞤓 inside 𞤲𞤓𞤵𞤳.



𞤣𞤣 IS FOR

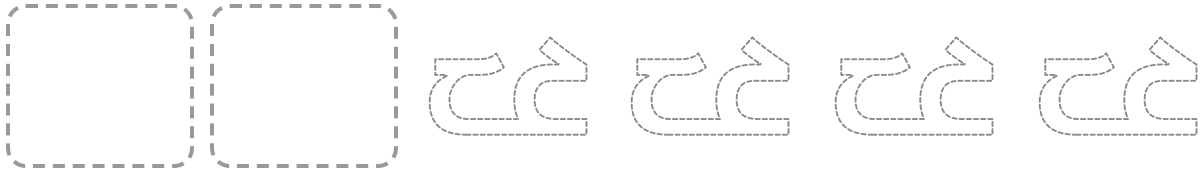
𞤲𞤓𞤵𞤳

KAA-ƴeh

rocks, hills

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤼𞤢𞤲𞤫𞤤𞤫𞤲



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𞤆

NAME · 𞤆𞤢𞤫𞤲𞤵

𞤆𞤵𞤣𞤆

waw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

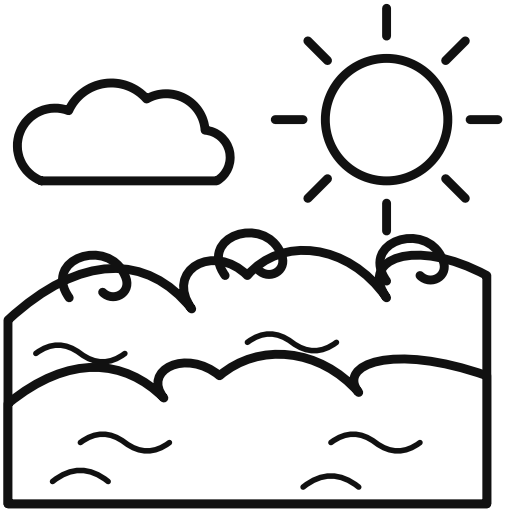
‘w’ as in “water”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤆 𞤆 W w

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤆𞤵𞤆



𞤆𞤵 IS FOR

𞤆𞤢𞤼𞤭𞤲

WEEN-doo

pond, lake

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤆𞤢𞤫𞤲𞤵

𞤆𞤵𞤆 𞤆𞤵𞤆 𞤆𞤵𞤆 𞤆𞤵𞤆

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𞤲

NAME · 𞤲𞤢𞥅𞤥

𞤲

nun

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

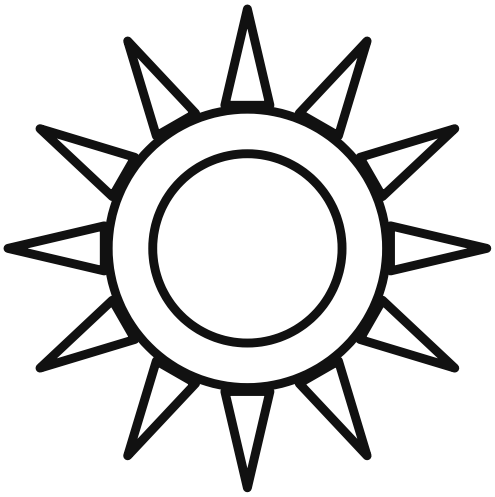
‘n’ as in “net”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤒 𞤲 N n

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤲𞤲𞤲



𞤲𞤲 IS FOR

𞤲𞤢𞥅𞤫𞤲

NAAN-geh

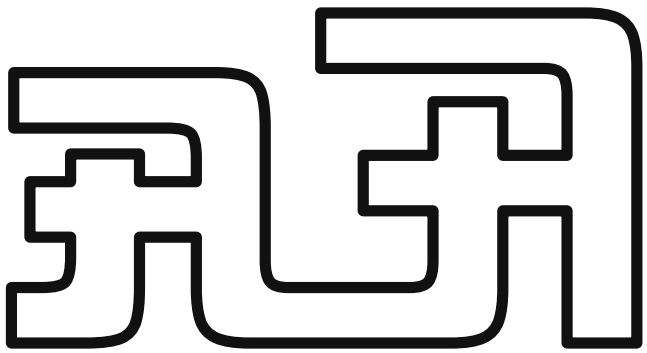
sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤲𞤢𞥅𞤫𞤤𞤫

𞤲 𞤲 𞤲 𞤲 𞤲

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NAME · 𞤀𞤤𞤥𞤢𞤤

𞤆𞤢𞤣𞤢𞥅

kaf

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

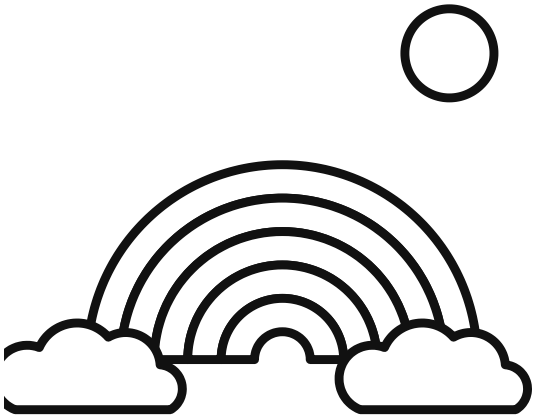
‘k’ as in “kite”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤆 𞤢 K k

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤆𞤢𞤆



𞤆𞤢 IS FOR

𞤆𞤢𞤣𞤢𞥅

KAM-moo

sky

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤀𞤤𞤥𞤢𞤤𞤢

𞤆𞤢 𞤆𞤢 𞤆𞤢 𞤆𞤢

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𞤘𞤣

NAME · 𞤑𞤫𞤥𞤢𞤤

𞤘𞤣

ya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤘 𞤣 Yy

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤘𞤣𞤘



𞤘𞤣 IS FOR

𞤘𞤫𞤧𞤭

YEE-teh

fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤑𞤫𞤥𞤢𞤤𞤲

𞤘𞤣 𞤘𞤣 𞤘𞤣 𞤘𞤣

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𞤅

NAME · 𞤅𞤫𞤤𞤢𞤥

𞤅

u

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘u’ as in “put”; with the long mark ◌̄ it is ‘oo’ as in “moon”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

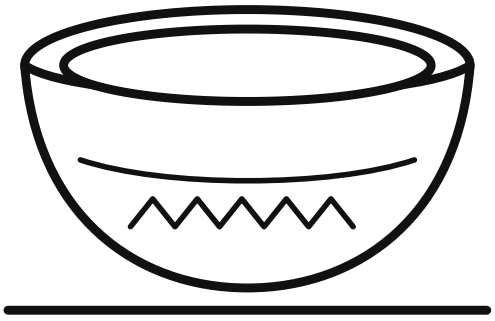
𞤀 𞤅 U u

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤅𞤅𞤅

Very few Fula words start with U. Find 𞤅 inside 𞤅𞤥𞤭𞤥𞤫!

𞤅𞤅 IS FOR



𞤅𞤥𞤭𞤥𞤫

TOOM-moo-deh

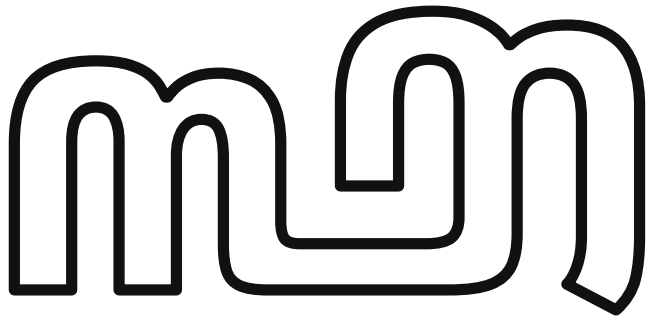
calabash bowl

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤅𞤫𞤤𞤢𞤥𞤣

𞤅 𞤅 𞤅 𞤅

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NAME · 𞤊𞤢𞤥𞤫

𞤒𞤭𞤭𞤥

jiim

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

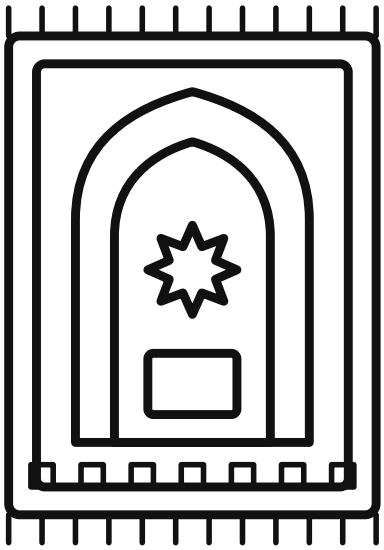
‘j’ as in “jam”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤒 𞤢 𞤒𞤢

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤒𞤢𞤒



𞤒𞤢 IS FOR

𞤊𞤫𞤲𞤮𞤤

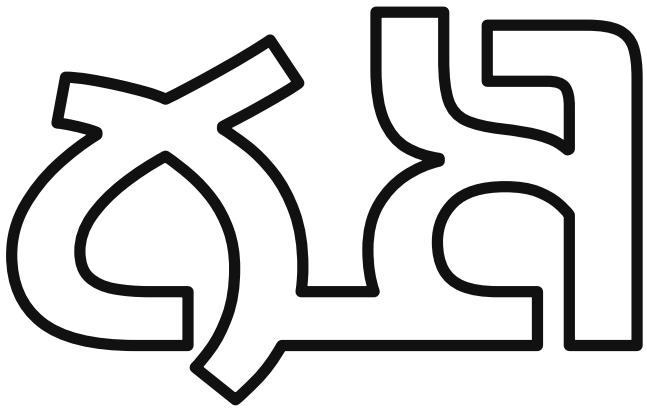
JOOL-deh

prayer (salah)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤊𞤢𞤥𞤫𞤤𞤢

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NAME · 𞤌𞤢𞤥𞤫

𞤆𞤢

chi

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤆 𞤢 C c

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤆𞤆𞤆



𞤆𞤢 IS FOR

𞤌𞤫𞤆𞤫𞤆

CHEH-deh

money

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤌𞤫𞤆𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥

𞤆𞤢 𞤆𞤢 𞤆𞤢 𞤆𞤢

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𞤤𞤢

NAME · 𞤀𞤓𞤥𞤫

𞤤𞤢

ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

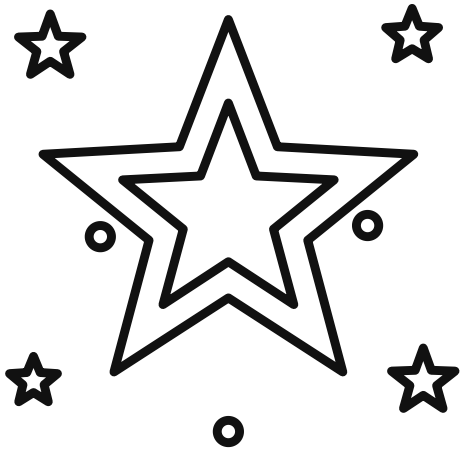
‘h’ as in “hat”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤄 𞤤 𞤤𞤢 **H h**

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤤𞤢𞤤𞤢



𞤤𞤢 IS FOR

𞤤𞤢𞤣𞤢𞤪𞤫

HO-ɗeh-reh

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤈𞤓𞤢𞤭𞤔 𞤀𞤔 𞤑𞤫𞤊𞤫𞤔𞤫

𞤤𞤢 𞤤𞤢 𞤤𞤢 𞤤𞤢

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𞤒𞤢

NAME · 𞤀𞤍𞤂𞤫

𞤀𞤍𞤂𞤤𞤢𞤥

qaaf

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘k’ said far back in the throat — used in words from Arabic

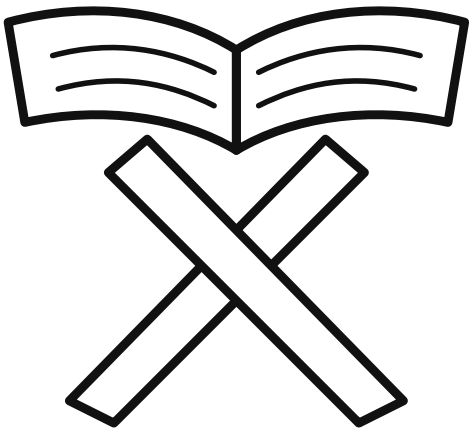
CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤒 𞤢 Q q

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤒𞤢𞤒𞤢

Q comes in words from Arabic, like the name of the Qur’an.



𞤒𞤢 IS FOR

𞤒𞤢𞤔𞤭𞤳𞤢𞤔

qur-AA-nah

the Qur’an

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤔𞤢𞤀𞤂𞤫𞤤

𞤒𞤢𞤒𞤢 𞤒𞤢𞤒𞤢 𞤒𞤢𞤒𞤢 𞤒𞤢𞤒𞤢

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𞤂𞤢

NAME · 𞤀𞤊𞤒𞤫𞤤

𞤂𞤢

ga

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

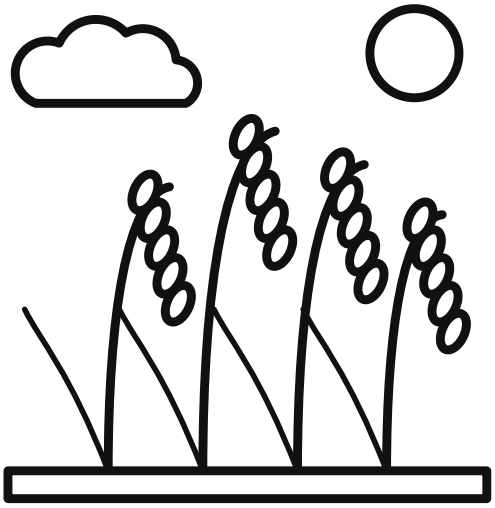
‘g’ as in “go”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤂 𞤢 G g

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤂𞤂𞤂



𞤂𞤢 IS FOR

𞤅𞤢𞤑𞤭𞤪𞤭

GAW-ree

millet (a grain)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤀𞤊𞤒𞤫𞤤𞤍

𞤂 𞤂 𞤂 𞤂

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𞤑𞤣

NAME · 𞤙𞤢𞤥𞤫

𞤑𞤣𞤲

nya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

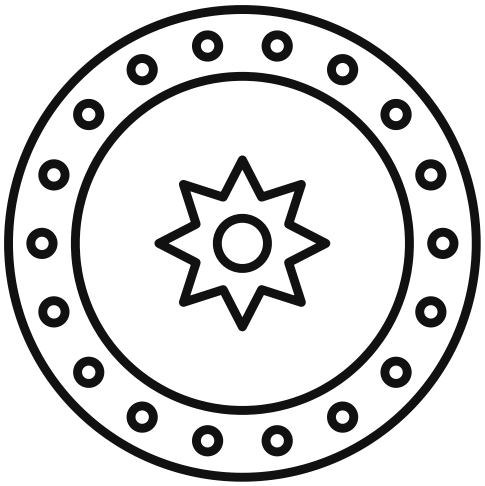
‘ny’ as in “canyon”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤡 𞤣 Ñ ñ

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤑𞤑𞤣



𞤑𞤣 IS FOR

𞤔𞤭𞤑𞤣

NYEE-ree

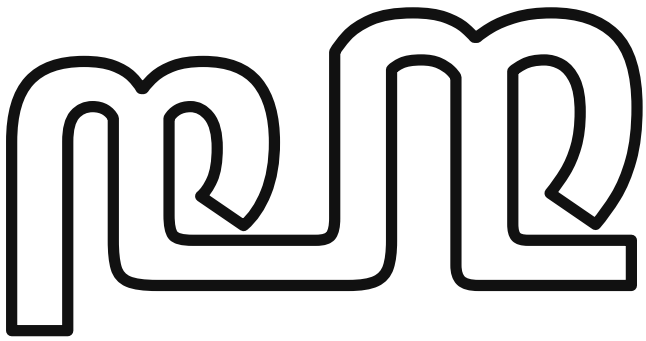
food (a cooked grain dish)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤙𞤢𞤥𞤫𞤲𞤤

𞤑𞤣 𞤑𞤣 𞤑𞤣 𞤑𞤣

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NAME · 𞤈𞤢𞤤𞤵

𞤈𞤥

tu

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‘t’ as in “top”

CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤄 𞤈 T t

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤈𞤥𞤈



𞤈𞤥 IS FOR

𞤈𞤢𞤣𞤥𞤮

TO-bo

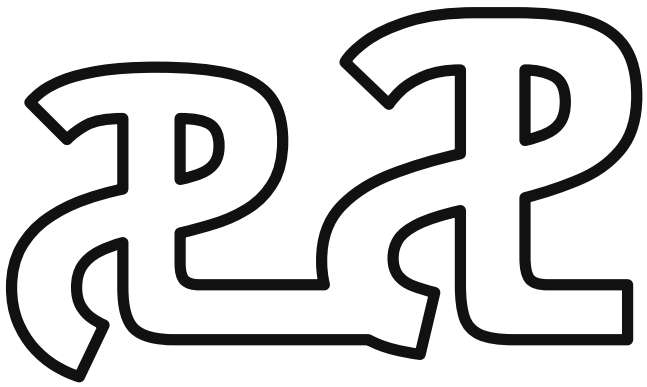
rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤈𞤢𞤤𞤫𞤤𞤲

𞤈𞤥 𞤈𞤥 𞤈𞤥 𞤈𞤥

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NAME · 𞤲𞤳𞤣𞤢

𞤲𞤳𞤣

nha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ng’ as in “sing”

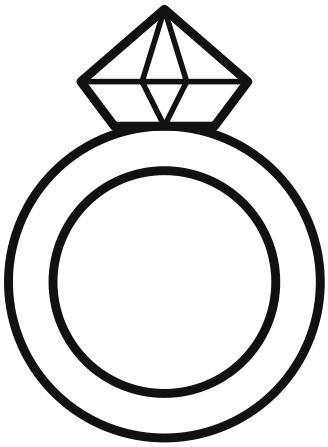
CAPITAL · SMALL · JOINED

𞤢 𞤢 Ŋ ŋ

Adlam capital · small = Fula Latin letters

Joined: 𞤢𞤢𞤢

Ŋ never starts a word. Find 𞤢 inside 𞤲𞤢𞤦𞤳𞤫!



𞤢𞤢 IS FOR

𞤲𞤢𞤦𞤳𞤫

KANG-ngeh

gold

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · 𞤼𞤳𞤢𞤦𞤢𞤲𞤣

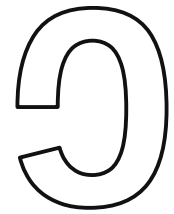
𞤢𞤢 𞤢𞤢 𞤢𞤢 𞤢𞤢

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BONUS

Fula numbers 𞤂𞤫𞤤𞤭𞤥 *(LIM-reh)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Fula: *ɓo-LUM*, *GO-'o*, *ƊI-ɗi*, *TA-ti*...



0

𞤄𞤮𞤣𞤵𞤥

ɓo-LUM

zero

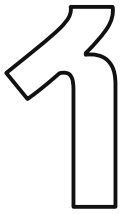


1

𞤺𞤮'𞤮

GO-'o

one

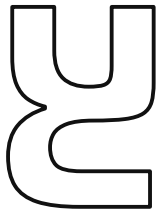


2

𞤊𞤭𞤣𞤭

ƊI-ɗi

two

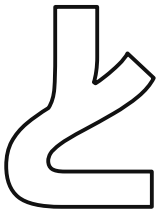


3

𞤈𞤢𞤲𞤼𞤭

TA-ti

three

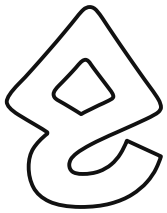


4

𞤑𞤢𞤲𞤪𞤭

NA-yi

four



5

𞤋𞤮𞤷

joy

five

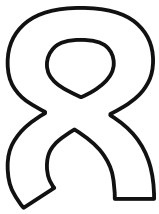


6

𞤋𞤫𞤴𞤺𞤮𞤥

JEH-gom

six

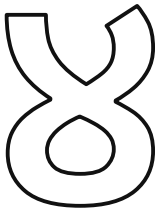


7

𞤊𞤭𞤊𞤭𞤴𞤺𞤮𞤥

jeh-ƊI-ɗi

seven



8

𞤈𞤢𞤲𞤼𞤴𞤺𞤮𞤥

jeh-TA-ti

eight



9

𞤑𞤢𞤲𞤪𞤴𞤺𞤮𞤥

jeh-NA-yi

nine

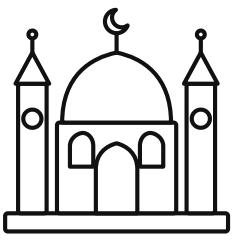
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LET'S TALK

My first Fula words 𞤊𞤢𞤲𞤣𞤮𞤲𞤫

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

𞤃𞤢𞤧𞤧𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥𞥅 𞤁𞤢𞤤𞤱𞤥𞤳𞤳𞤥	*as-sa-LAA-mu a-LAY-kum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
𞤁𞤢𞤤𞤱𞤥𞤳𞤳𞤥 𞤃𞤢𞤧𞤧𞤢𞤤𞤢𞤥𞥅 𞤅𞤢	*wa a-LAY-kum as-sa-LAAM* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
… 𞤲𞤫𞤧 𞤲𞤢 𞤑𞤭𞤣𞤫𞤤	*INN-deh am ko …* **My name is …**
𞤅𞤢𞤡𞤭𞤪𞤭𞤳𞤢 𞤳	*a jaa-RAA-ma* **Thank you**
𞤅𞤢𞤪𞤢𞤧𞤢𞤦𞤢𞤥 𞤁𞤢𞤡𞤭𞤳𞤢𞤡𞤭𞤳𞤢𞤥𞤭	*ja-ZAA-kal-LAA-hu KHAY-ran* **May Allah reward you with good**
𞤅𞤢𞤥𞤥𞤢 · 𞤅𞤢𞤦𞤢	*YUM-ma · BAA-ba* **Mother · Father**
𞤑𞤢𞤤𞤭𞤧𞤭𞤣𞤮 𞤳𞤮𞤪𞤳𞤮 · 𞤑𞤢𞤧𞤫𞤣𞤮 𞤑𞤢𞤤𞤭𞤧𞤭𞤣𞤮 𞤣𞤫𞤦𞤦𞤮	*mu-SIƊ-ɗo GOR-ko · mu-SIƊ-ɗo DEB-bo* **Brother · Sister**
𞤄𞤮𞤲𞤳 · 𞤀𞥋	*eey · a-LAA* **Yes · No**
!𞤑𞤭𞤣𞤮 𞤅𞤢𞤪𞤢𞤧𞤢𞤥 𞤑𞤢𞤤𞤭𞤪!	*MI-ɗo JANG-nga pu-LAAR!* **I am learning Fula!**





REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

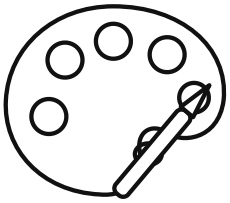
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International, all Fula varieties together); the story of Adlam from the **Unicode Standard** (Adlam block, 2016) and its inventors' published accounts.

What's next?
You have met all **28 Fula letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Fula, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ƁII KƆƆSAA ƓƆƊƊO! ƁII ƲƓƓAƝ ƑƲƊƊƐƝ!

MAA-sha AL-lah! a wa-ƊII MOY-ƴa! — Mashallah! You did well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 28 letters of the Fula alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



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An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
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